Hansie called me the next day and told me to deny everything. He was such a great captain and leader, everyone was in awe of him, and it was very difficult to say no when he asked you to do something – which was how I got myself into this bladdy mess to start with. I agreed with Hansie's request and kept my mouth shut.

I received similar advice from the head of the United Cricket Board of South Africa, the much respected Dr Ali Bacher. Of course he knew nothing about what had gone down in India, but he also told me to save my statements for an official inquiry, should one be opened. Under Hansie's instructions, I also denied any knowledge of match fixing to Dr Bacher.

As it began to emerge that the taped telephone conversations actually existed and pointed to match fixing in international cricket, the King Commission was set up in Cape Town to investigate the allegations against Hansie. Along with Hansie, Nicky, Henry, Pieter and I would be called before the commission to answer its questions. I was to appear before Justice Edwin King and Chief Prosecutor Shamila Batohi on 8 June.

To put it plainly, I was shitting myself. Hansie kept in touch during this time, wanting to know if I had spoken to anybody about the matter. And obviously every Tom, Dick and Harry was asking me questions. I kept my mouth firmly shut, though. I even denied everything to my much-trusted manager, Donné Commins, and my lawyer, Peter Whelan.

But in those months leading up to the King Commission, denying the truth took its toll on me. During a round of golf at the King David Golf Club in Cape Town I got a really bad migraine for the first time in my life. It was so bad I vomited on the course, and at one hole I chucked my club into a tree. I was so frustrated, I snapped my four-iron. Threw my toys completely. Obviously my actions and symptoms were all stress-related. In fact, the whole match-fixing episode was the most stressful time I have ever experienced. Knowing that I was consistently lying, week in and week out, wasn't nice at all. Ja, I had months of sleepless nights worrying about this thing.

Although Hansie and I had decided that we would deny everything, eventually I couldn't do so any longer. As I said, the stress was really getting to me. I remember sitting down with teammate Mark Boucher at the Long Street Café in Cape Town about a week before the King Commission was due to start and, over a bottle of Jack Daniel's, we had a long chat about what I should do.